

Day 4 — Stair-Step Method (Nārāyaṇa)

Module: Magic Squares — Bhadragaṇita (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Apply Nārāyaṇa's algorithm to build a 5×5 square.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *bhadra-gaṇita* (IAST: bhadra-gaṇita; lit. ““auspicious arithmetic” — the Indian term for magic squares”)
- Big-kid trick! Nārāyaṇa (an Indian mathematician 700 years ago) taught how to BUILD a magic square step-by-step.

Show on the board: 1. Put **1** in the top-middle. 2. From 1, jump UP-and-RIGHT to put 2... but you fall off the top! 3. Wrap to the bottom row (same column). 4. Keep going!

The pattern looks like a horse jumping. “*That's why he called it the horse-step!*”

Children watch the teacher build a 3×3 step-by-step.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Class 3×3 Magic-Square Tournament* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.